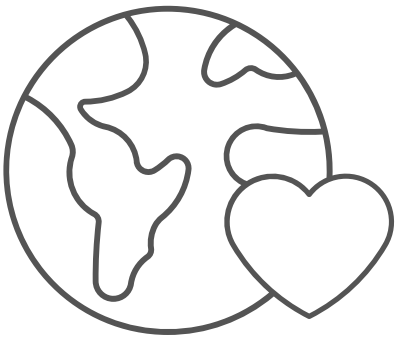


DEVELOPING A HEART FOR THE LOST

"The LORD is my shepherd; I shall not want." Psalm 23:1

What a sweet truth to know that it is the LORD who guides us. He is by our side, protecting us, caring for us, loving us. We have security in Him. But how would it feel if that wasn't true for you? If the opposite was true? "I am my own shepherd and I can't get enough of what I want." That is the reality of our unbelieving friends and the lost people all around us.

PSALM 23

Spend some time in Psalm 23. Rewrite each verse from the perspective of someone who doesn't know God. (ex. "I am my own shepherd;" "My parents or friends are the ones leading me.")

Questions for Reflection and Evaluation:

1. What stuck out to you?
2. How did this make you feel? How do you think someone who isn't a believer would feel if they understood this reality?
3. How do you think God views the lost? How does this change how you view the lost?
4. Who in your life does this make you think of? (Consult your prayer map/list.)
5. How can you better love your unbelieving friends in light of this?
6. What would it cost you?

"'I am the good shepherd. I know my own and my own know me, just as the Father knows me and I know the Father; and I lay down my life for the sheep. And I have other sheep too that are not of this fold. I must bring them also, and they will listen to my voice. So there will be one flock, one shepherd." John 10:14-16

Jesus is the shepherd leading and ultimately responsible over the sheep. He cares more about finding the lost sheep than we do and He has a plan to bring them into the flock.

Pray now for those not in the flock yet.

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